

Dr. Jehirul Islam – The Man on Mission Agar

Everyone finds an occupation that keeps them productively occupied. And then there are people who make their chosen occupation, a passion that transcends into a mission that changes the dynamics of the industry permanently. Dr. Jehirul Islam has emerged as the biggest evangelist of Agar wood, creating an industry that is giving a new identity to the North East states and a tangible source of income to the farmers there.



Dr. Jehirul Islam (Right Side) With Hon'ble Chief Minister of Assam Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma.

The son of Late Md. Abdul Rashid and Mrs. Jaynun Nesa, Dr. Jehirul's early life was in the peaceful environs of Khumtai in Assam. With a degree in Commerce, he pursued IT and finance, equipping himself with courses that helped him start a professional career as an e-commerce consultant at DISL Mumbai in 1999. He then moved to Saudi Arabia to work as an assistant financial controller for Toys "R" Us at Jeddah. In 2008, he stepped down as the Assistant financial controller to return to Assam.

In Assam, Dr. Islam started his research and development of Agarwood which is a fragrant dark resinous wood used in incense, perfume, ittar and small carvings. Agarwood is also used for various other purposes. Nurturing the right species from perfect mother plants, his research helped in the discovery of a result-oriented Agarwood fungus for inoculation of non-infected Agarwood trees. He has patented a new technology for the distillation of Agar Oil. This ground breaking technique is bound to change the dynamics of the business.

Dr. Islam's vision is to popularize Agarwood among the masses. Motivating farmers to plant more Agarwood, he has been instrumental in planting more than 44 lacs Agarwood saplings across the entire Northeast since 2012. Training unemployed youths, he has motivated huge youngsters to set up processing units for Agar oil.

Dr. Islam took a step for legalizing Agarwood, liaising with the various state governments, giving consultations and helping in drafting a comprehensive Agarwood Policy. His effort in promoting Agarwood business has influenced the governments of Assam and Tripura. On July 22, 2019, The Government of Assam made the historic decision on legalizing Agarwood for the indigenous people of Assam. His untiring efforts led to the laying of the foundation stone of the historic International Agarwood Trade Centre for Agarwood farmers and Traders on 21st October 2020 and the momentous Assam Agarwood Promotion Policy 2020 on 18th December 2020. Dr. Islam says, "This visionary decision of the Honorable Chief Minister of Assam Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma will have far reaching consequences in legalising the Agar trade, benefiting the indigenous Agar tree growers. Agar oil processing units in Assam can grow like cottage industry with a potential to become a business of more than Rs 50,000 crore".

Dr. Islam has also researched and developed the best varieties of healthy fragrances for Oudh, French and premium quality perfumes that are eco-friendly and good for health, skin and hair. Enriched with rich herbal ingredients like Agar oil, Patchouli oil, Ginger Oil, Eucalyptus Oil, Clove Oil, Bay leaves Oil, Lemon Grass, Sandal Oil, Zafraan Oil, Amber, Musk, Fruity Oil, Floral Oil etc. the products are refreshing and relaxing.

For his immense contribution in the Agarwood Industry, he has been recognized and rewarded, time and again. Some of them include :

- Assam Inspirational Award 2020,
- Time Stellar Brands And Icon Assam North East Award 2020,
- Byatikram Pride of North East Awards 2020,
- Utkrist Award for Green Entrepreneur of the Year 2021
- Times Best Agarwood Plantation Motivator of Assam
- Times Business Award 2019,
- Byatikram Lifetime Achievement Award 2019
- The Business leader in the field of Agarwood from TIMES OF INDIA GROUP & many more

Dr. Islam has got a Certificate of appreciation from the Former Chief Minister of Assam, Present Union Minister for Ayush, Port And Shipping etc, Shri Sarbananda Sonowal in 2020.

The smiles of contentment in the faces of the lakhs of farmers and youngsters who have found a vocation because of his efforts, will be the greatest reward for Dr. Islam. We say, there are a crore more faces waiting to light up as he marches ahead.

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